



"Making us Pay More for Sloth",
April 7, 2008

"Though reforms are needed to improve the bureaucracy's efficiency, denying them a reasonable salary hike does not hold merit."

M. HANUMANTHA RAO, *on e-mail*



Pay Omission

Even if government servants are offered a hike of 142 per cent, India will continue to be on top of the "Most Corrupt Nations" list ("Burden of Sloth", April 7). Accountability on the part of the government staff is the need of the hour.

V.K. NAIR, *Mumbai*

The article was highly biased. If what was stated in it was correct, there would have been anarchy in society.

A.K. KHANNA, *Delhi*

That the proposed hike in the salaries of government servants is not going down well with the intelligentsia is evident from the widespread criticism in several newspapers and periodicals. It is a simple case of feeling jealous of the neighbour's prosperity.

HARISH KUMAR PRAJAPATI,
Saharanpur

Despite all the shortcomings in the system, it is bureaucracy alone which is responsible for taking the country to such heights that it is recognised for its stupendous growth in several fields.

M.A. AHAD, *on e-mail*

Spewing venom on bureaucrats is okay but a few examples should not be used to undermine the merits of others who toil in trying circumstances and put in innumerable honest hours to make the government machinery function.

RUNJHUN KUMAR, *on e-mail*

The Sixth Pay Commission should have worked out a system that would link employees' salary with their performance. They should not get a handsome amount at the end of every month simply for warming the official chair for eight hours a day.

S. BALAKRISHNAN,
Jamshedpur

INDIA TODAY may well have questioned the proposed salary hike by firstly, comparing it with the average per-capita income of the common man, and then, by accountability. But it would be interesting if the magazine studies comparative figures of salaries in other countries of the size, population and complexity as that of India.

S. BALAKRISHNAN, *Jamshedpur*

Goan for a Toss

Though there has not been a major drop in tourist arrivals in Goa, a single incident has made a serious dent on the state's reputation ("Dark Side of the Sun", April 7). Sooner the state government springs into action to find a solution to the problem, the better it would be for the people.

BAL GOVIND, *Bareilly*

Scarlette Keeling's murder has opened up a Pandora's

box in Goa. Instead of it being a dream destination for tourists, it has become a stronghold of the drug and building mafia, where paedophiles and sleaze traders run amok. It would be better if the government started screening foreign tourists and kept out those with dubious credentials.

RANJANA MANCHANDA,
on e-mail

Matchless Dragon

The monk, no matter, how fretful he is of Beijing's cultural insensitivity, is no match for the Chinese monster ("Monk and the Monster", April 14). Since a large portion of China's foreign exchange reserves is invested in US-dominated assets, it cannot rap China on the knuckles and the monk could just become George Bush's cat's paw for settling trade-related scores with Beijing.

KANGAYAM R. NARASIMHAN,
Chennai